Diego A. Mesa

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EDUCATION

Doctoral Candidate in Bioengineering December 2015
University of California, San Diego

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering December 2010
University of Florida, *Gainesville, FL* (honors)

EXPERIENCE

Graduate Researcher, **Neural Interaction Lab** Aug. 2011 – Present
Developing novel theoretical and numerical techniques that make *efficient* use of *information* and are *scalable* with special applications to the design of global health decision tools.

Undergraduate Research Assistant (REU) Jan. 2010 – Aug. 2011
Working on a DARPA funded Cyber workstation project with a multidisciplinary team of neuro and computer engineers from different universities to construct a *portable* and *powerful* brain-machine interface workstation capable of running a closed-loop B.M.I experiment with live animal robotic control where the rigorous model computation is performed off-site.

Integrated Product and Process Design Aug. 2009 – Aug. 2010
Working with Raytheon Corp. on a yearlong research and development of a C++ based prototype of a multi-touch video teleconferencing application with military considerations involving an innovative and scalable user interface.

Software Engineering Intern, Lockheed Martin May 2009 – Aug. 2009
Worked on the Joint Strike Fighter as a Java developer on the ALIS web interface for fleet management. Worked closely with all branches of the military and other customers to ensure the quality of the product. Responsible for maintaining an ITAR security awareness and handling sensitive material.

PUBLICATIONS

- S. G. Kim, R. Ma, **D. Mesa**, T. P. Coleman, *"Efficient Bayesian Inference Methods via Convex Optimization and Optimal Transport", IEEE International Symposium on Information Theory (ISIT)*, 2013
- M.J. Harbert , S.S. Rosenberg, **D. Mesa**, M. Sinha, N.P. Karanjia, and T.P. Coleman, *"Demonstration of the Use of Epidermal Electronics in Neurological Monitoring"*, Proceedings of the American Neurological Association Annual Meeting, 2013
- P. Rattanatamrong, A. Matsunaga, P. Raiturkar, **D. Mesa**, M. Zhao, B. Mahmoudi, J. DiGiovanna, J. Principe, R. Figueiredo, J. Sanchez and J. Fortes, *"Model Development, Testing and Experimentation in a CyberWorkstation for Brain-Machine Interface Research", Proceedings of the 32nd Annual International Conference of the IEEE Engineering in Medicine and Biology Society*, 2010

CONFERENCES & TALKS

Invited Speaker, Dept. of Pediatrics – Joint Statistics/Epidemiology Seminar Oct. 2014
Poster, Systems On Nanoscale Information fabriCs (SONIC) Annual Meeting Sep. 2013
Poster, Center for Science of Information (CSOI) Annual Meeting June 2013
Participant, Society for Hispanic Professional Engineers Nov. 2014

TEACHING

Organizer and Instructor, Scientific Computing Workshop	2013 – 2014
Guest Lecturer, Probability and Statistics for Engineers	Fall 2013
Teaching Assistant, Thermodynamics	Winter 2013
Teaching Assistant, Biostatics	Spring 2012
Teaching Assistant, Senior Design	Fall 2012

SERVICE

Graduate Advocate, Summer Training Academy for Research in the Sciences (STARS) Sum. 2012, 2013

- Served as a graduate advocate for 5-8 underrepresented minority undergraduates participating in the summer research program. Dedicated over 20 hours a week to tutoring, essay writing, graduate and fellowship applications.

Member, Society for Hispanic Professional Engineers (SHPE)	2006-2011, 2014 – Present
Member, Society for Neuroscience (SFN)	2012 – Present

HONORS

Recipient, NCFDD – Faculty Development Boot-camp Scholarship	Fall 2014
Recipient, **National Science Foundation – Graduate Research Fellowship**	Fall 2011
Recipient, UIUC-MERGE Conference Scholarship	Fall 2010
Recipient, UC-Berkeley EDGE Conference Scholarship	Fall 2010
Recipient, Summa Cum Laude Graduate from College of Engineering	Fall 2010
Recipient, College of Engineering – Dean's Scholarship	Spring 2010
Recipient, Deans List – University of Florida	Fall 2007 – 2009